

Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC



DAVID AND SUE CAIRNS'

AUSTIN-HEALEY 100 BN1

SEPTEMBER 2010

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Contributions from members are welcome, however the Club accepts no responsibility for the accuracy, reliability or opinions of any article or correspondence herein.

The Club's postal address is:
AHOC (NSW) Inc, PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750
(ABN: 87 630 303 136)

Email:

austinhealeynsw@ozemail.com.au

Website:

www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

Contributions for the magazine can also be emailed to the editor at:
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

This beautiful 100 BN1 was almost like part of the family. We take a closer look and David's son Tim shares his memories. Story on page 10.

Flat Chat

SEPTEMBER 2010

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DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

2010

SEPTEMBER

- 10-12 • Festival of Speed on Tweed
- 19 • AHOC Picnic Day at Mitchell Park, Cattai
- 25 • Bowral Tulip Festival
- 25-26 • Alpine Classic Rally

OCTOBER

- 6 • GEAR Day
- 7 • Central Coast Waters Cruise.
- See page 4 for details
- 16-22 • Charlie's CCC – Contact Charlie Britten (02) 9809 0498 for details

NOVEMBER

- 6 • Drive to Quinn's home at Kurrajong Heights as part of Australian Open Garden Scheme followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel
- 14 • Vehicle inspection day at Richard Horwood's residence
- 27 • Fish and Chip run to Pan and Doug Ross's home

DECEMBER

- 8 • Christmas Dinner at Rydalmere Bowling Club
- 19 • Car display at Kincumber High School

If you have any questions about the above events please contact our club secretary Pamela Ross on (02) 4332 0075 or 0408 436 595. For competition events contact Patrick Townshend on 0407 075 997

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

TERRY BANCROFT

At the August monthly meeting Patrick Townshend, our very competent Competition Secretary voiced his concerns as to the association our Club has with the Combined Sports Car Association (CSCA). In an impassioned presentation Patrick raised his concerns that for the one event we organise each year, it entails a lot of work on the part of quite a number of members, for a small number who actually take part. Patrick raised the cost of staging the event, both for individual club members and the Club as a whole shared his thoughts on our Club leaving the CSCA.

Patrick's words generated quite a bit of helpful discussion from members both for and against the Club's involvement in competition generally. It was decided to air the question at the following committee meeting where it was decided to remain within the CSCA circle and continue with the holding of our event at Wakefield Park in the future.

Please note the Social report concerning the run to Caroline and Patrick Quinn's house and garden for a charity day has now been joined with our evening meal at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel on Saturday 6 November 2010. Please keep the day open as it should make it most enjoyable and interesting outing.

Winter is now finally over and the days are slowly warming. So there is no reason to keep the car hidden, let us see your cars and you and spouse at our next events.



CLUB COMMITTEE

2010

Club Patron
Ross Bond

President
Terry Bancroft
PO Box 3027, Llandilo NSW 2747
(02) 4777 4883 • 0409 323 133 mob
bangers@bancroft.id.au

Vice President
Doug Ross
13 Harbour Street, Bateau Bay NSW 2216
(02) 4332 0075 • 0408 436 595 mob
healey4me@activ8.net.au

Secretary
Pamela Ross
13 Harbour Street, Bateau Bay NSW 2216
(02) 4332 0075 • 0408 201 226 mob
healey4me@activ8.net.au

Treasurer
Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave., Wyoming NSW 2250
(02) 4328 4582 ah • (02) 9995 1963 bh
0413 589 306 mob
phillipsjames@optusnet.com.au

Social Secretary
Patricia Bancroft
PO Box 3027, Llandilo NSW 2747
(02) 4777 4883
bangers@bancroft.id.au

Editor
Patrick Quinn
116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758
(02) 4567 7380 ah • 0417 673 065 mob
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

Competition Secretary
Patrick Townshend
Mob 0407 075 997 • chopperpat@yahoo.com

Historian
Joe Armour
5/150 Abbotsford Rd., Picton NSW 2571
(02) 4677 3999
sebring@illawarra.hotkey.net.au

Membership Secretary
Christine Lyttle
2 Hall Street, West Ryde NSW 2114
(02) 9874 6080 ah • (02) 9291 2836 bh
christinelyttle@hotmail.com

Regalia
Richard Horwood
(02) 9764 4000 • 0408 233 592 mob
rfhx3@live.com.au

Technical Officer
John Dowsett
12/76 Gibson Ave., Werrington NSW 2747
(02) 9623 5037 • 0414 231 934
jdowsett@tpg.com.au

Club Registration
Patrick Quinn (As Above)

Public Relations
Richard Horwood (As Above)

Non-Committee Positions

Competition Assistant
John Kent

Librarian
Stuart McColl

CMC Delegates
Ray Roberts/Charles Britten
Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Terry Bancroft

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

Flat Chat is published on behalf of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW (Inc) by Vintage Racecar Journal Pty Ltd., 116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758

The opinions expressed in *Flat Chat* are not necessarily those of the Editor or the AHOC (NSW) (Inc).

MIDWEEK RUN TUESDAY 12TH OCTOBER 2010



Our next midweek Austin-Healey Owners Club run promises to be a most interesting and different type of day out. We will meet at the Woy Woy jetty (near train station) at 10:00am for a 10:15am departure aboard the passenger launch Codock 11 - a 40ft boat with copper sheathed, oregon planking and varnished teak interior. The ferry was built in 1945 and used to ferry workers to and from Cockatoo Island until these dockyards were decommissioned in 1991.

After cruising around the magnificent waterways of Brisbane Waters for 2 hours we will alight for lunch at the Davistown RSL. Then at approx 2:30pm we will be picked up for our return launch trip to Woy Woy.

The cost for this cruise is a mere \$12, with lunch at "The Davo" at your own expense. As this is a group booking we need to guarantee numbers beforehand. To secure your place on this cruise, please pay your \$12 to Allan Whitehouse or Charles Britten by 30th September at the latest. Bookings will be taken on a "first-come" basis.

Once again, details are:

Date: Tuesday 12th October 2010
Place: Woy Woy jetty (near train station)
Time: 10:00am (cruise departs at 10:15 sharp)
Cost: \$12 for cruise. Lunch at your own expense
Payment: \$12 to Allan or Charlie by 30th September
Contacts: Allan (8765 8708) or Charlie (9809 0498)

There has been a lot of interest in this run already so book early to ensure you don't miss out.



Greetings and welcome to the September 2010 issue of *Flat Chat*. First of all I am pleased to say that our magazine continues to attract interest from organisation that wish to advertise their wares. Over the last few months you may have noticed such new advertisers as T Wall & Sons, motor trimmers from Brookvale and last month there was AutoMaster Auto Electrics from Burwood. There are a few others in the wings who have seen it worthwhile having their name in your magazine. Of course advertisers in *Flat Chat* don't just do it for warm feelings and actually pay cash money so that you know about them. So I ask that if you have a need of their services give them a call and let them know where you found out about them.

In this month's issue we have all the normal reports on what is happening within the Club. So if you want to know what you missed from the August monthly meeting have a look at the Secretary's report on page 6. I don't know about you, but I find the recently introduced 'Show and Tell' segment at the monthly meeting to be really enjoyable. So if you do have some Austin-Healey memorabilia that is particularly close to your heart bring it along to the next club meeting for everyone to enjoy. Talking about enjoy – it was great to see John Sherman and Eric Rudd at the August meeting after quite a long absence.

Our feature car this month is the 100 of David and Sue Cairns'. Sadly David passed away in early July and Sue was very kind to allow me a chat about David's association with sports cars in general and his 100 in particular.

Many years back I had the opportunity to be up close and personal with a Mercedes-Benz 300SL Coupe. Gorgeous car with its evocative gull-wing doors and glorious race bred 3-litre fuel injected straight-six engine. Apart from all that, what really impressed me was the matching set of fitted luggage and since then I have thought that such a thing would be just perfect in an Austin-Healey.

I have read that fitted luggage could be had for your 100 from some aftermarket accessory manufacturers, but I have never seen an example. So when I saw an article in a recent issue of *Healey Marque* of a fellow owner in Omaha, Nebraska who had made his own I had to include it in *Flat Chat*. Many thanks to Reid Trummel the editor of *Healey Marque* for his kind permission.

Our new member this month is Scott Whyman who hails from St Ives in Sydney. Actually Scott has owned his BJ8 for close on to 8 years, but living in Singapore until late has made it a little difficult to use. Longer term members will be interested that Scott's car is the same BJ8 that was raced so successfully by Peter Hopwood in the early 1970s.

Once again many thanks to Don Hardie on some wise words on fitting a headlight relay to your Austin-Healey. Wise words also from John Dowsett on keeping your cool over the forthcoming summer.

Our Moment in Time this month comes from Dave Mould who

tells us of a couple of close encounters of the 100S kind he has had. Please if you have a photo or two of your own personal Austin-Healey history; send them along to me along with an explanation. Don't worry about the grammar and other boring stuff – leave that to me.

On to the classifieds and we have two cars for sale this month plus some words on recent auctions that might be of interest. By the way I don't have a problem in advertising interstate or non-member cars, as I see it all as a service to club members.

Talking about the classifieds I have recently had a Lucas moment with my car. When it was restored during the late '70s and early '80s I removed the old harness very carefully, stripped off the old covering and then soaked it in a strong laundry detergent solution for about a week. Out it came, a good squirt from the hose and after it was perfectly dry and clean had it bound in the original patterned cloth thread.

It performed perfectly for 25 years when all of a sudden it developed a hole and some of the smoke came out causing the driver's side headlight to stop working. So the first thing I did was to try and find the hole and then locate a genuine Lucas Replacement Wiring Harness Smoke kit. It's part number 530433 by the way and I also found a very rare Churchill Tool 18G548BS adaptor tube and metering valve. I recommend that we all keep some in the boot for just such an emergency.

Thankfully fellow member Keith Taylor of Wamberal had everything I needed in amongst the pile of spares he advertised in last months *Flat Chat*. However be warned as I bought Keith's last kit and they are very hard to come by. You might be lucky as I have seen them advertised at <http://www.mez.co.uk/lucas.html>

I hope you enjoy this month's *Flat Chat*.





■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE:

11TH AUGUST 2010

MEETING COMMENCED: 8.35 PM

Apologies: Tony Williams, John Dowsett, Neville Stirton, Greg Denning, Alan Mitchell.

New Members/Visitors: Guest Speaker: Brett Baxendale (State Manager Sta-bil fuel stabiliser - NSW/ACT) Michael Skura.

■ PRESIDENT

• Unfortunately the run to the Perthville Pub near Bathurst did not attract any interest from members, and was cancelled at the last moment.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

• Nil

■ SECRETARY

Outgoing Correspondence:

- Thank you to Avis Fowler from the Austin-Healey Sprite Club for her assistance at the Wakefield Supersprint.
- Condolence card sent to Heather White on Athol's passing
- Get well wishes to Ken Krause (and Jenny) following Ken's cancer surgery.

Incoming Correspondence:

- Invitation from MG Car Club NSW – see their calendar at www.mgcar-clubsydney.com.au to attend a Driver Training Day on 5th Sept at Marulan.
- Letter from Kerry Bayliss (Rotary Club Kariong) thanking us for our participation and sponsorship of Hand Brake Turn. Funds raised were nearly \$23,000 overall through the raffle etc.

Magazines Received from:

- TR Sidescreen
- Hundreds and Thousands (AHOC - Vic)
- Healey Torque (AHOC - Qld)
- BMC Leyland

■ TREASURER

Jim Phillips advised that there was just over \$12,000 in the Club's Cheque account as well as \$77,000 within the cash management just account. There are a number of accounts outstanding. It has been decided that the proceeds from this year's Brass Monkey Run will start the Club's bank for the 2013 Rally.

Jim also advised that he still has tickets for the All British Display Day, scheduled for Sunday 29th August.

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY

• Picnic run to Mitchell Park at Cattai on 19th September. We have been advised that if it has been raining during the week preceding, we will not be able to use the area. It has been suggested that we start the run from different locations – Thompsons Corner, Berowra Checking Station and the Shell station at Sutton Forest. Mitchell Park was where the club had its first social run during the late 1960s and the current operators of the Park have asked for copies of any photos members may have of that event.

• A Club run is being planned followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel.

• Presentation Breakfast in January next year will be at Cameron and Belinda Sell's home at Winmalee.

• Speed on Tweed – official entry tickets are cheaper if they are purchased before the day. See Patricia for details.

• Yass – Celebration of Heritage Motoring. Patricia has the details.

• An evening with Bob Holden – Patricia has details.

• Mid-week run to Wisemans Ferry this coming week to bowling club 12.15pm

• Charlie's run in October – details coming soon about final payment.

• 'Wings over Illawarra' next Feb 27th – promises to be a magnificent day.

Our concours will be held on that day. John Kent organising our display etc.

■ EDITOR

- Looking for photos of early days of the Club showing members and cars.
- Anyone about to rebuild an engine? Please let Patrick know as he'd like to do an article on this.

■ COMPETITION SECRETARY

• Chris Komor, John Dowsett, Steve Sheppard and Colin Goldsmith attended the FoSC Wakefield Park race meeting at the weekend. Chris and John both posted best personal times and attended GEAR day today. Steve

Sheppard commented at the FoSC meeting.

- Eastern Creek Supersprint this weekend.
- Another Supersprint by the Austin-Healey Sprite club on the following weekend.
- Patrick Townshend has raised the matter that our Wakefield Supersprint is becoming too much to undertake for small number of members?

1. Don Read as a founding member would like to see it continue. Colin Goldsmith and others agree.

2. Ray Roberts/Alan Mitchell mentioned that we would need to look at affiliations.

3. Steve Sheppard mentioned we would like to see more members involved in competition. It can be embarrassing that we have low support – often due to expense.

4. The forms and paperwork can be quite intricate. Helpers can be hard to source at the end of the day. We need someone to help with the documentation.

5. The club will need a racing competition secretary from next year on. Such a person does not necessarily need to participate in racing to do this. Just need to be organised. There is no need to attend every event, but preferable to attend CSCA meetings (7 a year) plus running our own event.

6. Further discussion at next week's committee meeting.

■ HISTORIAN

• Nil

■ REGALIA/P.R.

• Nil

■ LIBRARIAN

• Club Magazines are available through the library

■ CLUB REGO

• Nothing to report

■ MEMBERSHIP

• 31 members at meeting.

■ GENERAL BUSINESS

• CMC – RTA bringing in a rule that if a vehicle has four alterations it will require an engineering certificate so that it must then meet the current Australian Design Rules. However it does not apply to vehicles built before 1989. CMC addressing this in future weeks.

• All British Display Day – Sue Darlington sent a message that she attended meeting last night and that our spot will be almost the same as last year. For the special display of a 100 cars for 100 years, vacancies remain for 1967, 1988 and 1989.

• V8 Supercar Fathers Day Service – Sunday Sept 5th at Kincumber High School.

• FLAT CHAT magazine advertising has increased its funding. At present we are continuing with monthly magazine.

■ FOR SALE/WANTED

• Nil

■ SHOW AND TELL

• Ray Roberts – Photo of trophy presentation at Winton two years after Alan Jones was killed in an accident near the circuit. The Jones family donated the perpetual "Alan Jones Trophy". The photo showed the trophy being awarded for the first time by Mrs Jones, Alan's mother.

• Don Read – Barbie Healey (smaller version) as a clock radio.

• Christine Lyttle – eBay purchase of model Austin-Healey friction car.

• Patrick Quinn – Duncan Industries badge from England – two badges on Healey Duncan saloon. Ian Duncan built the Duncan Dragonfly in 1947, ten+ years before the Mini. He sold the car to Austin and also went to work for them. The car lay unused in air-raid shelter that was being used to store unused material, and eventually scrapped. This badge survived.

• Colin Rule – Original ticket to the dinner held at the Australian Jockey Club rooms in 1977 to commemorate the visit to Australia by Donald Healey. The ticket was given to Colin along with a linen serviette signed by Donald by Ross Bond who also sat with DMH that night. Colin also presented Ross Bond's original racing suit.

MEETING CONCLUDED: 9.40PM

Hello everyone. August was certainly a busy month with four events for the competition minded plus the display days stage by Shannons at Eastern Creek and the All British at the Kings School. Perhaps that's the reason why there seemed to be such a complete lack of interest in the lunch run to the Perthville Pub near Bathurst?

Anyway September is providing lots of opportunities for members who wish to use their cars. The picnic day run to Mitchell Park will bring back memories for some of our long term members as it was the destination for the Club's very first run back in the late 1960s.

I look forward to see you out and about in your Austin-Healey.

SEPTEMBER – 10th – 12th - Speed on Tweed - Murwillumbah. **Sunday 12th** - Community Fun Day and Car Show at Campbelltown East Public School 9am to 3pm. Cost is \$10.00 per vehicle. If interested please contact me. **Sat/Sun 18th – 19th** HSRCA Race Meeting Wakefield Park. **Sunday 19th** - Picnic day Mitchell Park, Cattai. Departing at multiple meeting spots - Thompsons Corner, Pennant Hills at 10am, the Berowra checking station at 10am and the Shell service station, Sutton Forest at 9.30am. Or drive yourself to be at the park at 11.30am. Travel along Windsor Road towards Windsor and turn right on to Pitt Town Road at McGraths Hill. Proceed along Pitt Town Road until it changes into Cattai Road and Mitchell Park Road is the second on the right after Long Neck Lagoon. Entry is \$7 per car by cash or card. If there has been rain the week before the alternate venue is Wisemans Ferry Park. If in doubt call Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133. **Saturday 25th** - Bowral Tulip Festival Street Parade 3.p.m. This year is the 50th year of Tulip Time. Please advise me if you are attending as they require numbers. **Sat/Sun 25th – 26th** - 2010 Alpine Classic Rally. Contact Lui MacLennan on (02) 9460 6909 or 0418 645 623.

OCTOBER - Wednesday 6th - GEAR Day at Wakefield Park. **Tuesday 12th** - Central Coast Waters Cruise. Aboard the old Cockatoo Ferry "Codock 11" departing and finishing at Woy Woy with a lunch stop at Davistown RSL. Cost for the cruise only is \$12 (collected beforehand) and lunch is extra. Contact Charles Britten on (02) 9809 0498. **16th to 22nd** - Charlie's Coffs Coast Cruise. Contact Charles Britten on (02)

9809 0498. **10th or 24th** - To coincide with the commencement of Daylight Saving I am aiming to organise an evening dinner run. More details in next month's Flat Chat.

NOVEMBER – Saturday 6th - Classic Yass Car Show. "Yass Celebration of Heritage Motoring". Please contact me if you need information regarding this event. **Saturday 6th** - A drive to Caroline and Patrick Quinn's home at Kurrajong Heights for afternoon tea followed by dinner at the Kurrajong Heights Hotel. Caroline and Patrick have been asked to open their garden as part of the Australian Open Garden Scheme. Entry to any garden open as part of the AOGS is \$6 per head, with proceeds going to charity. Afternoon tea will be able to be purchased and there will be stalls selling gifts etc. The Kurrajong Heights Hotel is a short distance away. Meet at the parking area opposite the RAAF base on Windsor Road, Clarendon and departing at 2pm. **Sunday 14th** - Vehicle inspection day at Richard Horwood's abode. BBQ and tea/coffee available. More details in next month's Flat Chat. **Saturday 27th** - Fish and Chip run to Pam and Doug Ross's home 13 Harbour Street, Bateau Bay. Leaving in convoy from the old checking station at Berowra. More details in later issues of Flat Chat. **Sat/Sun 27th – 28th** HSRCA Tasman Revival, Eastern Creek.

DECEMBER - Wednesday 8th - Our Christmas Dinner to be held at Rydalmere Bowling Club. No club meeting this month. Prices will be \$15 for members and \$25 for non-members. **Sunday 19th** - Car Display at Kincumber High School with Carols by Candlelight. More details later in the year.

JANUARY '11 – Sunday 16th - AHOC Presentation Day to be held at Belinda and Cameron Sell's home at Winmalee. Details will be provided later in the year.

FEBRUARY '11 – Sunday 27th - Our concours will be held in conjunction with "Wings over Illawarra" and Austin-Healeys will be the marque car for the event. There will be no entry fee for Austin-Healeys. John Kent is organising this day for the club, so please keep the day free as we would like a great roll up.



COMPETITION SECRETARY'S REPORT

PATRICK TOWNSHEND

Over the weekend of 7-8 August 2010 the Festival of Sporting Cars converged on Wakefield Park, south of Goulburn for their Winter Invitation race meeting. Competing from the AHOC was Chris Comor in his 100, having his first foray into Regularity and John Dowsett in his Austin A90.

I understand that a blown welsh plug kept John in the garages on Saturday, but he was out there enjoying himself in three set races on Sunday. As usual the meeting was extremely well run so much so that it was possible for a Butcher's Picnic to be held later on Sunday. If you don't know what this means, it's when anyone who wishes is allowed out on the circuit irrespective of class or type of vehicle. John reports that this was his most enjoyable race of the weekend as he found himself up and amongst it with an Alfa Romeo and Datsun 240Z until he missed a gear and he was left to circulate on his lonesome. I also understand that Chris Comor was more than

pleased with his 100.

Just to show that their exploits were more than flashes in the pan, both Chris and John attended a GEAR day the following week.

On Saturday the 21st of August I participated in a Supersprint at Eastern Creek along with Cameron Sell. As usual Cameron's car performed exceptionally well and was very quick down the straight. My car however developed a dislike for its own fan belt and bought the day, and my fun to an early end. Next month I will be able to report on the Sprite Car Club's round at Eastern Creek.

If anyone is interested I currently hold the Supplementary Regulations for a hill climb on Mount Panorama held by the Bathurst Light Car Club on the 29th of August. Perhaps the thought of a race on the mighty Mount may be too much, but what about driving up the mountain in the opposite direction to the race cars? Don't worry there are no other cars coming the other way. ■

Profile: Scott Whyman



Name: Scott Whyman

Occupation: IT Management

Where Do You Live? St Ives - Sydney

What model Austin-Healey? 3000 BJ8 Mk3

Why did you buy an Austin-Healey? Honestly I think the Austin-Healey is the most iconic and beautifully designed motor vehicle in the whole world. And on top of that they still have a level of performance equivalent with modern day cars.

For as long as I can remember I have said to anyone who would listen that as soon as I was in a position to buy one I would.

We had been living in Singapore for some years, but would come back to Australia for holidays. It was in 2003 and we were back primarily for the Rugby World Cup, but thought we would do a little touring through Victoria's Yarra Valley. I have also owned a Mk1 Sprite for some years and while in Melbourne thought it would be a good idea to drop in on the Healey Factory to renew a few acquaintances.

There it was sitting on the showroom floor looking just wonderful in its metallic blue and it was love at first sight. So while I went out to buy some wine I ended up buying an Austin-Healey.

Did you specifically set out to buy the model that you bought? Heavens no! I wasn't looking for one at all and I certainly wasn't looking for a BJ8.

While I knew in the back of my mind that the BJ8 was the best of the desirable models I can't say that I was across all the differences between the various versions. I recall thinking that by the development and release of the BJ8 the marque had reached its peak and it was surely the best of the lot. (Probably not a view shared by us all. PQ)

I saw it in the Healey Factory showroom and was immediately drawn to it. It was probably its

colour and that it was in such great condition. It had been obviously restored and when I had my first drive I knew it was certainly nice and tight. Prior to that I think I had driven just two Austin-Healeys so I sought of knew what to expect.

It really confirmed my thoughts that an Austin-Healey has the sense of real racing and performance pedigree and it's a time capsule of design features. So very 1960s with those gauges to watch and the powerful engine up front.

What was it like when you bought it? It was in excellent condition and ready for touring whenever I wanted it to. As I mentioned we were still living in Singapore and it was my intention to use the car when we would return for our Christmas holidays. Well that was the intention, as apart from one memorable trip through the Hunter Valley anything else has been few and far between.

What was interesting about the car was that it came with a huge history file, almost a patchwork of handwritten notes on what had been done to it. Initially I didn't take much notice of it and then a year or two back I started to have a look through it. I noticed that apart from notes that it also contained a number of newspaper clippings showing that the car was owned by Peter Hopwood.

Then I found Chris Dimmock's website that not only shows Chris' car racing during the 1970s but Peter Hopwood racing the car I now own. It was a real revelation for me to see the car in action, as until then I had no idea that the car had anything interesting in its history. It was registered ERG 179.

As far as I could see Peter ran it successfully for 3 or 4 years in the early 1970s. It all added to the attachment to the car and coincided to our return from Singapore to Australia.

Are you looking forward to using it? Certainly am! We moved back to Sydney in April this year and the car is currently having some work done to it. I am told that it should all be ready for the road in a couple of months and one of the reasons I was so keen on becoming a club member was to join in on club events. ■



Warm Weather Ahead: Stay Cool

With the warmer weather fast approaching, and as foreshadowed last month let's look at the problem of overheating, and suggest how you can overcome this.

1. Of course, first and foremost, your cooling system must be in good working condition. Merely fitting a larger fan will not help if the radiator is choked up with debris and the cooling tubes are blocked. In fact if your radiator is working efficiently a larger fan may not be essential, although it will always help. So if you are experiencing continual overheating problems and unless your radiator has been recently cleaned and pressure tested, or if you have any doubt as to its condition, this is a good starting point. It also helps to retain the air deflectors that were placed when you car left the factory.

The cost of a clean out and pressure test at any reputable radiator repair centre is around the \$100 mark, and this seems a modest outlay to solve the problem, especially if you can remove and replace the radiator yourself. Of course if your radiator core is beyond redemption there would be the additional cost of replacing the core.

2. At the same time you clean or replace the radiator core, have a good look at your radiator hoses and fan belt and replace these if at all doubtful. Also fitting an in-line water filter will help greatly in preventing the internal tubes from

clogging up again with loose flakes and particles in the cooling water.

3. A word of advice here – be aware that a good radiator will not necessarily cure your overheating problem if your motor is out of tune or in bad general condition. So the following items should also be considered: –

a) Your ignition system should be in good working condition and properly timed as discussed in earlier technical articles.

b) Your fuel mixture should be properly adjusted and your carburettors properly synchronised.

c) Idling speed should be adjusted to no more than say 600 to 700rpm. Idling too fast will tend to overheat the motor during extended delays at traffic lights. Also it is in this situation that a larger fan will be of greatest value.

Good luck for a cool running motor in the coming summer.



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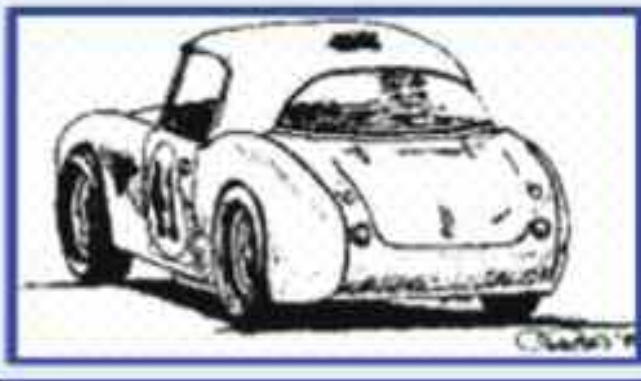
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David & Sue Cairns' Austin-Healey 100 BN1

Sadly, club member David Cairns died on July 3rd 2010. In his eulogy, son Tim said that from a young age his dad taught him that if he was going to own a car, the roof had to come off. Tim added that his dad said there were two other things about cars and these were that you had to be able to touch the rear wheel and the ground while sitting in the driver's seat and most importantly a proper car had to be completely impractical.

I recently dropped in on Sue Cairns to find out about David's attraction to sports cars and especially Austin-Healeys.

David's first completely impractical motor car was a Bug-eye Sprite that he bought from Geoghegan's Sport Cars in March 1970 for \$800. That was followed by a Lotus Elan that was David's number one love at the time. That was until it caught fire on a trip to Terrigal and ended up being not much more than a molten mess on the side of the road. Thankfully the insurance company came to the rescue with sufficient money for David to buy a MGB.

"We kept the MGB on the road until Tim was born." Sue said. "That was in 1981 and even David decided that it was time for something a little more practical, however David was determined that it wasn't to be sold so it was put on blocks, where it was stay for the next 20 years."

"That was the start of endless discussions on what British sports car that David wanted to buy next. David liked the MGB, but somehow the conversation always got around to Austin-Healeys. I knew it was getting serious in 2001 when we were on holiday in Victoria and David wanted to visit the Healey Factory. Of course we did and while there he test drove an Austin-Healey as well as a Triumph. I'm sure he drove the Triumph just to prove himself right that an Austin-Healey was the car he really wanted."

David's 100

"Later that year he saw an Austin-Healey advertised in the Sydney Morning Herald." Sue added. "It belonged to club member Spiro Halias and before long David had made a deal. He was delighted that Spiro agreed to take the MGB is part trade plus some cash."

"It certainly wasn't concours, but David loved it and loved being part of the club. He wasn't in the slightest bit mechanical, but that's what he liked about the club in that he could call on people to ask what could be done."

"When he got the car, David's life was measured by it as he never stopped talking about the car. He said the MGB really didn't compare, and the Elan, while a good car was really second after the Austin-Healey. It was everything to him."

"Not long after David bought the car his kidney started to fail." Sue said. "It was then he developed his wish list of things he would like to do to the car. Once again club members were extremely helpful. People like Don Hardie were always available with advice and John Dowsett would take on David's wish list with enthusiasm."

"John rebuilt the gearbox and repaired the clutch rods that were always causing problems. David thought spot lights were important to such a car, so he had John fit them too. He wanted to fit a louvered bonnet as well, but never got to it.

AHOC

"Being a member of the club was a big thing for David." Sue stated. "He loved going for club drives and went on Charlie's runs in 2002 and 2006. He was back on dialysis during the 2006 run to Port Macquarie, but that didn't deter him as he was able to undergo his dialysis after the day's events and be back out there the following day. Such runs were important to him as not only could he enjoy them, but he knew there would be others around to help if something went wrong with the car."

"Later when David could no longer drive his friend Gary used to come around and the two of them would go for runs in the car. He loved doing that."

"Tim is 29 and has driven the Austin-Healey all of 3 times." Sue added. "On the day after his father died he took it for a run to Manly where David had his favourite coffee shop. Tim says driving the car makes him feel closer to his father."

"The Austin-Healey became a very big part of David's life, especially as his health deteriorated and he became very tired. He used to love going out to the garage and clean and polish the bodywork. It was very therapeutic for him."

"The future? I like the thought of going for runs in the Austin-Healey, as it makes me feel as I'm with him."





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Extracts from the eulogy for David Roy Cairns – 18.11.51 to 3.7.10. Prepared by Tim Cairns.

Dad was born at the Jacaranda Hospital in Caringbah. After two years in Caringbah they moved to Pennant Hills where for a lot of time dad shared a room with his brother Don. When they were 10 and 8 my aunt Anna arrived and my grandparents doted on her. So Don and Dad, decided to make it their mission to stir her as much and as often as possible. Luckily stirring was something that always came naturally to my Dad.

His upbringing was normal, but school was not smooth for Dad. As a kid with malfunctioning kidneys he was small and often sick. His fifth and sixth grade teachers underestimated his academic ability and strongly recommended he quit at the end of year 10. My Grandfather felt Dad should have the same opportunities as his brother and kept him in school. Instead he went to James Ruse Agricultural High School.

I couldn't do Dad's eulogy without mentioning his cars. From a young age I was taught that if you were going to own a car, the roof had to come off. You had to be able to touch the rear wheel and the ground while sitting in the driver's seat. And above all it had to be completely impractical. In his time he owned an Austin-Healey Bug Eye Sprite, Lotus



Elan, MGB and in 2001 he bought his favourite car from childhood, an Austin-Healey 100.

As soon as he got his Healey he joined the Austin-Healey Owners Club. I'd like to thank the club, in particular Charlie Britten and David Wallace for accepting Dad like one of there own, even though he hardly knew the difference between a Philips head screwdriver and the one with the flat end.

The year 1978 was definitely the biggest year of Dad's life. Having being diagnosed with kidney disease at 14, Dad's kidneys finally failed when he was 27. He went on dialysis and was lucky enough to receive a kidney transplant 6 months later. With a second chance, Dad was determined to live a normal life.

Part of Dad's normal life was playing tennis and he took on the challenge to organise the first Australian Transplant Team to compete at the 1980 World Transplant Games in New York. While the first Australian team consisted of just 12 transplant recipients, he continued to organise the next few teams and founded the Australian Transplant Sports Association, which is now known as Transplant Australia.

Needless to say Dad was one of the biggest advocates for introducing a doubles event to the games. He competed at games in NYC, Athens, Amsterdam, Innsbruck, Singapore, Budapest, Vancouver and Sydney. One hundred people now represent Australia at each World Games.

Dad was the first life member of Transplant Australia and their first president. He was also the first Australian councillor elected on the World Transplant Games Federation. And in 2000 was awarded an Australian Sports Medal from the Governor General.

Macquarie University

When Dad wasn't going to Transplant Games, he was at Macquarie University. He loved working at Macquarie, but the best part of his 40 years there, was meeting my Mum. They were married in 1979 and two years later had their first



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child, the other one (sister Heather) came along in 1983.

As a son, it was nice to see that Dad felt that way about Mum all the way to the end. Whenever she walked into the room at the hospital his face would noticeably light up. And the first thing would say when opening his eyes was; "Where's Sue? Mum and Dad

had a better supervisor. David was always positive and encouraging no matter what life threw at him. I have never met a more generous and understanding individual who will always remain with me as a significant shaper of my life and my beliefs. David will hold a special place in my life as a positive role model, as an exceptional teacher and as an embodiment of acceptance and perseverance."

Dad liked to start debates with people. About anything and everything. He would normally have his argument pretty well thought out before he started, so it was rare to win one. But he had an answer, for if you ever did win.

"I may be right. I may be wrong. But you're going to miss me when I'm gone."

As usual. He was right.

were married 31 years.

Dad was a lecturer and this would carry on to when Heather and I were in trouble. We wouldn't just be sent to our rooms, but sat down and received a lecture.

And like a real lecture, it would have an introduction on why we were in trouble, a middle and a conclusion. This took a while, so Heather and I used to sneakily time him. The day he set his record of 48mins 24secs also happened to be the day he realised he was being timed.

Heather and I couldn't have asked for a better dad. He never wanted to make our decisions for us. We were always allowed the freedom to make our own mistakes. Whenever we had a problem or sought advice, he had the ability to listen to us with the ear of a friend and the love of a father.

In 1991, Dad completed his PhD. It was on, Quality of life for people living on Dialysis. This wasn't just an interesting topic for Dad. It was his life's goal. To not let any medical issue get in the way of him living a normal life.

I've always felt incredibly lucky to have such a great role model on how to approach life. But it's been lovely to see throughout the years that it wasn't just my family that felt this way about Dad. He would always receive letters and cards from students and friends. We received this last week, which seems to sum up how people saw him.

"David was a constant source of inspiration for me. My research explored meaning in life and happiness and I could not have

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Custom-Fitted Luggage

*by Joe Johnson, Omaha, Nebraska
Austin-Healey Club of Kansas City*



*Joe's Healey,
with fitted
luggage neatly
filling the boot.*

I have always been fascinated with the custom luggage designed specifically for the automobiles of the past, and have also wondered what they would look like and where they would be located in an Austin-Healey 3000. Several years ago I came across an ad in a car journal that appeared to be selling luggage for an Austin-Healey 100. The photo of the luggage was from the 1950s and for the cost of a few pounds, one could purchase two different-sized rectangular suitcases which would fit into the flat-floored boot area of a 100.

My thoughts quickly turned to the challenge of actually making a set of "fitted luggage" for our 1962 3000 Mark II BT7. After all, what could be so difficult to shape some luggage which would fit in the boot of the BT7 and compensate for the projecting hub on the spare tyre, the cover for the fuel filler tube, the battery, the shape of the front bulkhead and least of all, the curved shape of the boot lid?

The first task at hand was to determine the shape of the volume in the boot. Since I run Dunlop Roadspeed 5.90x15 tyres on the car, the volume is a little more generous above



The underside view reveals the recess needed to clear the spare wheel hub.

the spare. Next came the design process with the thought, "What would Donald Healey and Gerry Coker have done?" to ensure the luggage was sympathetic to the overall design of the car. Hopefully the final result would be worthy of their approval.

After preparing a set of rough dimensional drawings and cutting a few templates, I began the search for the materials suitable for the luggage shells. I knew cardboard would not be appropriate (if the original shapes were to be retained over a number of years) even though it would be inexpensive and easy to cut by hand. After considering my meager set of hand tools that consisted of a pair of scissors, a hobby knife, a plastic miter box and a box saw, I chose a pallet of 1/8-inch thick wood fiberboard, an assortment of 1/4, 3/8 and 1/2-inch basswood strips, and several widths of 1/8-inch thick wood planks. The final covering for the luggage

would be a red Vynide type material that matched the interior of the car. The hardware would include chromed coachman loops for the straps (similar to the one for the spare tyre tie-down strap) and hinges to match those used for the glove box door on a BJ8. The lining for the luggage would be grey felt.

The task of cutting and fabricating the wood shells for the luggage can best be described as trying to assemble a set of miniature kitchen cabinets. All the fiberboard panels were cut to size and edged with the varying sizes of basswood strips. Then, panel by panel, I put them together using aluminum jigs set up on my work counter. This was the only way I could keep everything square during the assembly and gluing process.

I first thought I would like the seams for the Vynide covering to have black welting that matched the car's seat coverings. However, after several futile attempts to replicate this joint, it was discarded due to the bulk generated at the seams and corners where it must turn in three different directions. Out of desperation, a "French seam" (sorry, Donald and Gerry) was tried and a relatively professional joint was achieved. After the luggage was covered, the interiors were lined with felt and the hardware was installed. It turned out the lining of the luggage was one of the more difficult and lengthy tasks.

Our BT7 has participated in several car shows since the addition of the luggage. I have enjoyed sitting on the sidelines and listening to comments from the visitors who drag others over to view the luggage, some of which are convinced the luggage is original. The expressions are priceless when I say, "I made them," and I am sure I didn't convince many of those who asked. I am now restoring a white BJ8 with a red interior. I am starting to visualize a three-piece set of fitted luggage for the rear fold-down parcel shelf. ■



Austin-Healey 100 Headlight Relay

Sometimes I think the light from the headlights of my Austin-Healey travels forward a foot or two and then instantly

sinks to the road. I thought a few other members may be experiencing the same, so I ask Don Hardie for his thoughts. Don's response centered on shortening the distance the electricity has to travel while reducing the number of connections. --PQ

Over the years the Lucas push-in connectors corrode in their sockets, you could disconnect each one and either replace or polish it to its original condition, but you are still left with the circuitous route of the wiring and wires which to my mind are too small. This starts at the regulator and goes to the headlight switch on the dashboard and then ducks down to the dip switch beside the clutch pedal, before returning to the other side of the car and the connectors above the left hand front suspension. This might not seem like a long distance, but as far as a 12 volt low wattage system is concerned it's a long way.

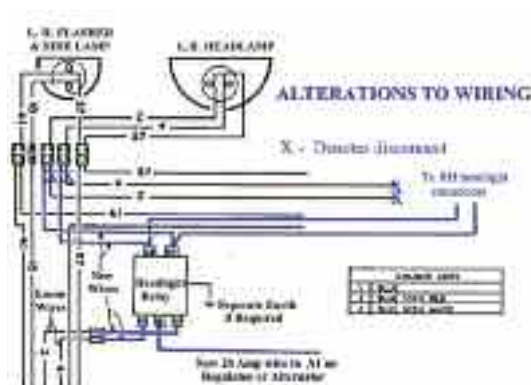
One way around this is to install a relay system that uses the wiring already in place to supply power to operate only the relay. As the relay requires low amperage to operate it, voltage loss does not really come into the equation, as the headlight operating power goes straight from the regulator or alternator through the relay to the lights by the most direct route.

Confused? Well don't despair as we will now get down to the nitty gritty. Fused high and low beam headlight relays are available from most parts suppliers for about \$34 and you will also need 2 metres of 20amp wire. However



running two 20 amp wires (approx 4 metres) would probably be better if you wish to run 120 watt high beam globes (blue would be nice as it is the standard Lucas colour for headlights), 4 male and 2 female blue crimp bullet connectors and some crimp ring connectors. I mounted the relay low on the right hand side (see photo). Connect the B terminal of the relay to A on the standard regulator, or alternator main terminal if fitted.

Disconnect the main loom blue with red trace (low beam) wire from the 4-way connector under the LH guard and connect with a new wire to S1 on the relay and connect H1 on the relay, back into the 4-way connector position where you removed the aforementioned blue with red trace (low beam) wire. Do the same for high beam (blue with white wire to S2 and new wire from H2 on the relay). You may also require an earth wire depending on the relay. The extra wire coming out of the each of the



terminals in the photo are because I disconnected the two original wires going across to the right hand headlight connectors and ran two from the relay to those connectors under the right hand side.

Not only do you have a shorter connection from the regulator or alternator, but the lights now have fuses which the original system didn't. Cleaning the 4 way connector, the 2 way one on the right hand side and connections to the headlights would not go amiss.

Don't worry about the other relays in the photos, the one below the headlight relay is for an electric fan and the three on the shroud support are for fog and driving lights.

P.S. 6 Cylinderites will have to check the position of the connectors on their cars, but the fitting should be similar. ■





We are indebted to long term member Dave Mould for this month's Moment in Time photos. The photos are of two separate 100Ss that have crossed Dave's path during the early 1970s.

The blue 100S (registration DGY 111) was originally owned and raced by Sam Miller and by the beginning of the 1970s was owned by Peter Owen and Mark Rutty on Sydney's Northern Beaches. In early 1971 Mark Rutty sold his share of the car to Peter Owen, known as Pedro to his friends. Then a month or so later Pedro allowed Dave to borrow the car. It turned out to be a loan for over 4 years, after which the car was sold on to Victoria.

The maroon car (registration OAH 100) was first owned and raced by Ron Phillips in South Australia. During the early 1970s it was found languishing in a garage at the Sydney beachside suburb of Coogee. It was Peter Owen who found out about the car and he let Ross Bond know where it was and that for some dollars the owner could be persuaded to part with it.

We all know what a 100S is worth today, but in the early 1970s it was just another old sports car and frankly wasn't worth all that much. While Ross wasn't in a position to buy the car, there was a concern amongst club members at the time that unless the car was moved out of the garage it may be lost forever.

So six club members (including Dave Mould) each paid out \$200 to buy the car. Yes a quick mental sum will tell you that for \$1,200 the five were owners of a 100S.

They didn't keep the 100S all that long when it was sold on to Ray Jorgenson in Queensland. Dave Mould recalls the car was transported to Queensland on the top of a semi-trailer and he saw it loaded on to the trailer by a forklift truck. Dave saw it again 1976 when he trailered his 100 north for some work to be undertaken. ■



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Auction News

As mentioned last month there were a few cars coming up for auction over the weekend of 14 and 15 August 2010 in Monterey, California. Okay I realised that it's a long way from downtown Sydney, but it's worthwhile keeping an eye on what prices are being achieved for premium cars. After all if you were really serious, what is to stop you having a car perfectly restored here and selling it for top dollar through one of the world's top auction houses?

First of all there was the Nash-Healey Le Mans Coupe that was expected to bring somewhere between US\$100,000 and US\$125,000. Well unless you put a minimum price on sometimes there are those who are disappointed and others who drive away happy. The Nash-Healey fell short of the expected \$\$\$ at US\$77,500 (Aus\$87,230).

Remember the 100M at the RM auction at Monterey that was expected to achieve between US\$125,000 and US\$150,000. Well they weren't far wrong as it went under the hammer for US\$145,200 or Aus\$163,500. That was after the M that sold at Monaco a couple of months back for Aus\$154,600. The surprise sale was the very pretty, but slightly unoriginal early single light BJ8 that sold for US\$126,500 or Aus\$142,390.

Around the Monterey Peninsula at Pebble Beach was the Gooding & Company auction which over the weekend sold an amazing US\$64,590,000 (Aus\$72,723,000) worth of cars. Playing a small part in this was a 1955 100 BN1 that was touted as an M, but was actually a BN1 fitted with a Le Mans kit. It was hoped that this car would sell for around US\$150,000, but it was seen for what it really was and sold for US\$71,500 or Aus\$80,500. There is no such thing as a BN1 100M.



Over the last month there has been the usual selection of Austin-Healeys on eBay, and the one that took my eye was a 1954 red BN1 in Lakeland, Florida. Unusually it was an original RHD car and was also fitted with a Le Mans kit.

The ad said that it was sold originally in the UK and imported into the US during the early 1960s. Plus after its restoration the car had been a consistent concours winner. All its numbers matched, it was rust free and apart from minimal oil in all the usual places the car was in very good condition.

The car was placed on eBay with an unknown reserve price and received quite a bit of attention. A little bit of searching revealed that its reserve was a realistic US\$41,000 (Aus\$46,200). Despite this the bidding didn't go past US\$31,000 and the car remains in Florida.



CLASSIFIED ADS



For Sale - Austin-Healey 3000 Mk3 Late 1967, original right hand drive model with Heritage Certificate. Chassis no. HBJ8/42736 and engine no. 29K-RU-H/17420. Restored in the US and imported in 2009. New interior, 72 spoke chrome wire wheels, new hood and paintwork. Most of the other chrome work is good, particularly the bumpers. I am not sure what mechanical work has been done, but it holds good oil pressure, does not overheat and in the little I have driven the car it pulls well and clutch and drivetrain seems fine. While certainly not concours it presents well and would suit someone wanting a car to use regularly without paying for a pristine example. Currently unregistered. Asking \$69,000. Please phone Peter Lance on 0408 246 464.



FOR SALE - 1960 AUSTIN HEALEY 3000 BT7 MK I Heritage Certificate. Body off restoration - everything rebuilt or replaced. Prepared for competition. 3.3 litre engine and fitted with solid billet stroker crank, Cosworth pistons and alloy cylinder head (Denis Welch), roller rockers and triple Weber 45 DCOE carbs. Also fitted with close ratio centre shift gearbox and overdrive, Detroit locker diff, 4-wheel discs and aluminium radiator. Bond roll bar, 2 x SA harnesses and tonneau cover. This car was built by Neil Dunn for competition. At the time Neil had the quickest Austin-Healey in Australia and lessons learnt from his car were duplicated into this. Car is now virtually brand new and has had just 5 hours running on club plates. Can be road registered. Please contact Peter Ford on (02) 9982 4829, 0412 084 062 or peterford@live.com.au

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Out Regalia Officer Richard Horwood has a small number of specials this month. These include 2 x XXL and 2 x L micro fibre Austin-Healey polo shirts as well as 4 x Austin-Healey Racing matching baseball caps. If you interested give Richard a call on (02) 9764 4000 or 0408 233 592.


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The Mac Healey with Graeme Marks at the wheel out in front at Winton during May's Austin 7 race meeting. That's the Cooper Mildren at left and the Prad Holden Testa Rossa on the right. Neil Hammond Photo.



Brian Duffy and his 3000 at the HSRCA's Eastern Creek meeting of 1-2 May 2010. Photo by Steve Oom.



Colin Rule and Ross Bond's racing suit. Yes we were all that thin once.



Christine Lyttle shows off her latest addition to her model Austin-Healey collection.



Ray Roberts showing and telling at the August club meeting.



"If you want a closer inspection just look under the bonnet," Don Read says during August's Show & Tell.



Don't you just love the subtle differences in the cockpit of John and Judy Sherman's BJ8?



Brett Baxendale from Trico Products showing off his wares at the August club meeting. Those backs of heads belong to Don Hardie, Terry Bancroft and Steve Shepard.



David Pike showing at the Austin 7 2010 Winton meeting that the Streamliner can go around corners as well. Neil Hammond photo.



Mid-week run to Wisemans Ferry 17 August 2010. L-R. Muriel Roberts, Beverley and Barry Bowe (guests), Larry and Helen Johns, Val and Ralph Stedman (guests), Carol and Geoff Golding, Charles Britten, Ray Roberts, Colin Goldsmith, Kay Britten, Edna and Ron Cox (guests), David Williamson. Allan Whitehouse behind camera. Golding's Austin-Healey 100 and Whitehouse Austin-Healey 3000.